

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The nature of God: how the characteristics of God are shown in the Mool Mantar, Guru Granth Sahib 1, and why the characteristics are important and why the Mool Mantar is significant for Sikhs.
1.2	God as Creator: the nature and importance of God as Creator (Karta Purakh) for Sikhs; Sikh teachings on God as Creator, including Guru Granth Sahib 12 and 94.
1.3	The nature of human life: the purpose and significance of life as an opportunity to unite with God; Sikh understandings of why uniting with God is important; how uniting with God will affect their lives, including Guru Granth Sahib 12.
1.4*	Sikh beliefs about life after death: the nature of karma, rebirth and mukti (liberation); how they are shown in the Guru Granth Sahib, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 2, 11 and 78; divergent understandings of how and why karma, rebirth and mukti are important for Sikh life today.
1.5	Purpose of life: the nature and importance of being gurmukh (God-centred) not manmukh (self-centred) and the elimination of haumai (ego/pride), including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 125 and 226; what actions make a gurmukh Sikh; divergent understandings of why being gurmukh and eliminating haumai is important in Sikh life today.
1.6	The oneness of humanity: how the equality of all humans is shown in the Guru Granth Sahib, including Guru Granth Sahib 349; how equality is shown in stories from the lives of the Gurus, including the example of Mai Bhago and the appointment of women as teachers; and how equality is shown in Sikh life today; how and why complete equality of men and women is important for Sikhs today.
1.7	Sewa (service to others): the nature of sewa, including tan, man and dhan; the origins and purpose of sewa and its importance in the development of Sikhism, including Guru Granth Sahib 26; divergent understandings of the practice and importance of sewa in Sikh life today in reflecting the priority of service to others.
1.8	Sangat: the nature and history of the sangat; divergent understandings of why the sangat is important for Sikhs, including Guru Granth Sahib 1316; the concept of Sat Sangat and divergent understandings of its significance for Sikhs; problems for Sikhs living without a sangat.

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage in Sikhism: the significance and purpose of marriage in Sikh life; Sikh teachings about marriage, including the Lavan by Guru Ram Das; divergent non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and the Sikh responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Sikh teaching about the importance of sexual relationships: divergent Sikh teaching about sexual relationships; Sikh teaching on sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships, including Guru Granth Sahib 4 and discussion of the January 2005 edict of the Jathedar of the Akal Takht in Amritsar; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Sikh responses to them.
2.3	Sikh teaching about the purpose and importance of the family: Sikh teaching about the purpose of families – procreation, security and education of children, including Guru Granth Sahib 71 and 599; divergent Sikh responses to the different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the Sikh community: how and why the local community tries to support families, including through family worship, rites of passage, classes for parents, groups for children and counselling; the importance of this support in the sangat for Sikhs today, including Rahit Maryada Chapter 10.
2.5	Sikh teaching on contraception: divergent Sikh teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to the concept of kaam and The Sikh Missionary Society Introduction to Sikhism, Section VII: Sikhism & Modern Problems Q124; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them.
2.6	Sikh teachings about divorce: divergent Sikh teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage, including reference to Rahit Maryada Chapter 11 and arguments used to support or reject divorce; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them.
2.7	Sikh teaching about the equality of men and women in the family: divergent Sikh beliefs, teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family including Guru Granth Sahib 788.
2.8	Divergent Sikh teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Sikh teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination, including Guru Granth Sahib 473; examples of Sikh opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination.